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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Elon Musk outlined** ambitious targets for SpaceX, including launching data centers in space in 2027 and reaching \$1 trillion in revenue, as part of his first address to investors since the company's IPO. **A1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** continued their climb, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow rising 1.8%, 2.6% and 1.7%, respectively. **B11**
- ◆ **The Saudi Arabian Oil Company** delivered bumper profits through the first months of the Iran war, despite unprecedented disruptions to its operations. **B1**
- ◆ **Some Bilt cardholders** were hit with collections notices for overdue balances that weren't theirs, reports that hurt their credit scores. **B1**
- ◆ **McDonald's chose** a U.S. leader to help boost sluggish domestic sales and improve service and quality at the world's biggest burger chain. **B1**
- ◆ **Paramount's** streaming service continued to grow in the latest quarter, helping to offset another sales decline for its television unit. **B3**
- ◆ **Procter & Gamble** will buy supplement company Thorne for \$3.8 billion, reinforcing P&G's presence in the beauty and wellness industry. **B3**
- ◆ **Lufthansa shares** fell more than 8% in Frankfurt after the airline group booked a steep drop in second-quarter profit and turned more cautious on its full-year guidance. **B2**
- ◆ **OpenAI will pay** \$3.2 million to settle claims by the Justice Department that it discriminated against U.S. workers by allegedly favoring temporary visa holders from other countries. **B2**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Iran has staked** everything on controlling the Strait of Hormuz, gambling that Trump will prefer a messy, volatile stalemate over an all-out war. **A1, A6**
- ◆ **Votes were being** counted in the Michigan Senate primary, where the fight between Abdul El-Sayed and Rep. Haley Stevens was seen as a referendum on the Democratic Party's identity. **A5**
- ◆ **An armed man** observing security operations at Trump's golf course outside Los Angeles was arrested Sunday, days before the president was set to travel there, authorities said. **A3**
- ◆ **A 37-year-old** Spokane resident was arrested on a first-degree arson charge related to one of three major wildfires burning in eastern Washington state that have so far scorched thousands of acres. **A3**
- ◆ **A divided Senate** Judiciary Committee advanced Todd Blanche's nomination to be attorney general, after he committed in writing to killing a \$1.8 billion fund that had rankled key Republicans. **A3**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** released guidelines that would bolster Medicaid's oversight of autism therapy, focusing on a business being scrutinized by federal investigators. **A2**
- ◆ **The 2025 Eaton Fire** in Los Angeles that killed 19 people and destroyed thousands of buildings was caused by Southern California Edison equipment, fire officials said. **A5**
- ◆ **Russia is** coercing more fighting-age men into military service to boost the flagging ranks of its army. **A8**

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At 97 Years Old, She's Still Just Winging It



HIGH FLIER: A year after suffering a stroke, Betty Bromage of Cheltenham, England, became the oldest-ever female wing-walker, breaking her own record on Tuesday. It was her sixth wing walk since turning 87.

Iran Bets All of Its Chips on Control Of Strait

Tehran's maximalist stance poses risk of new escalation with U.S., economic harms

Iran's leadership has made a high-stakes calculation in its showdown with President Trump: maintaining control over the Strait of Hormuz is a nonnegotiable red line.

By Omar Abdel-Baqi, Benoit Faucon and Alexander Ward

By asserting authority over a critical waterway for global crude-oil flows, Tehran is betting that its ability to inflict pain on the U.S. economy is its best leverage to avoid future military action from the U.S. and Israel. With gasoline prices and inflation elevated, Tehran believes that Trump, a Republican, will ultimately accept its terms ahead of fast-approaching midterm elections that could determine the future of his presidency.

But centering its strategy on controlling the strait is an extraordinary gamble. It assumes Trump will prefer a messy, volatile stalemate over an all-out war. In playing this card so aggressively, Tehran risks miscalculating Washington's breaking point and threatening its own economic survival.

"Their maximalism will contribute to their isolation in the long run," said Behnam Ben Taleblu, an Iran expert at the Foundation for Defense of Democracies, a policy organization that opposes Iran's rulers.

There are fissures from
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- ◆ **Hormuz opening in limbo after new strikes**..... **A6**
- ◆ **Jordan pays the price for its alliance with U.S.**..... **A7**

Musk Sets Target of \$1 Trillion For SpaceX Revenue by 2030

For first quarter after IPO, rocket firm posts net loss, 92% rise in sales

By BECKY PETERSON

Elon Musk on Tuesday outlined ambitious targets for SpaceX, including launching data centers in space in 2027 and reaching \$1 trillion in revenue in 2030, as part of his first address to investors since the company's IPO.

The statement from the billionaire entrepreneur and SpaceX chief executive followed an earnings report that showed sharp growth in revenue across the company's three business lines: space, connectivity and AI. Revenue for the world's biggest rocket launcher and satellite-internet provider in the second quarter

totalled \$7.8 billion, up 92% from the same period last year. SpaceX, which raised \$86 billion in a record-setting initial public offering in June, reported a net loss of \$541 million. Its capital expenditures hit \$18.4 billion for the quarter, up from \$2.8 billion the prior year.

SpaceX shares closed Tuesday up more than 9%. But following the report and call, shares were down more than

8% in after-hours trading.

In a roughly hourlong call with analysts, Musk touted goals for the company such as SpaceX hitting \$1 trillion in revenue by 2030, moving up its previous projection to hit that goal in 2031. And similar to Tesla earnings calls, Musk and other executives answered questions from individual investors.

Musk has a history of shar-
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INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL 'Spider-Man' stars Tom Holland and Zendaya are spinning box-office gold. **A10**



BUSINESS & FINANCE McDonald's picks new head of its U.S. business to improve service and quality. **B1**

Lied on a Caltech Application? The 'Fraud Squad' Is Watching

By ROSHAN FERNANDEZ

At California Institute of Technology, a little-known band of admissions officials is scrutinizing the fonts on science-fair certificates, checking addresses on high-school transcripts and analyzing signatures on awards.

Known as the "fraud squad," these investigators are in charge of vetting applications to the highly selective STEM-focused school, which

admitted less than 4% of its 11,400 applicants for the incoming class. Caltech created the team two years ago partly in response to a rising number of anonymous accusations of dishonest submissions.

The four-person team inspects every admitted student's application, taking nothing for granted. They scour the internet to confirm obscurities, contact competition officials and high-school counselors and use a video-in-

terview program to suss out students' research claims.

At elite colleges such as Caltech, admissions have become more competitive and applications are increasingly complex. Some request long lists of accolades—research, competitions, awards and independent projects—that colleges can find harder to verify than grades and test scores.

At the same time, technology like artificial intelligence
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He Turned His Solitude Into A Movement

* * *
One man's plan to talk to strangers has taken off

By MATHYLDA DULIAN

Fin Colleton spent the early days of the pandemic like many people: alone in an empty house, isolated from anyone for three months at a stretch. So he made a sign reading "How's your day going?," walked to a Philadelphia park and waited.

What could go wrong? Against the odds, strangers stopped and talked. He returned again and again, each time with a new sign bearing another conversation prompt. People kept stopping.

A sign evolved into chairs; chairs evolved into a table. It
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ICE Scours Internet To Reveal its Critics

Agency says surveillance seeks threats to agents; others see speech curbs

By HANNAH CRITCHFIELD AND SHANE SHIFFLETT

For Tired_Thumb, no subject seemed off limits—until the Reddit user crossed a Homeland Security red line.

From January to mid February, the account posted 116 comments in 40 subreddits, covering everything from fireplace tiling to folk punk.

Tucked among the posts were three that criticized immigration agents.

By March, Tired_Thumb was embroiled in a constitutional legal battle.

In recent months, ICE has deployed a round-the-clock digital dragnet to scour the public internet—from Facebook to Instagram to X—for

speech that could endanger the agency's mission. The government has paid millions to private contractors to surface everything from potential threats to agents to activities that could disrupt ICE's operations, according to federal documents, contractors and former Homeland Security Investigations agents.

The program has ensnared U.S. citizens and activist groups that alert community members about ICE activity. Contractors prepare daily reports and dossiers on threat actors, identifying the poster's name, location, date of birth, workplace, Social Security number, vehicle registration and criminal
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